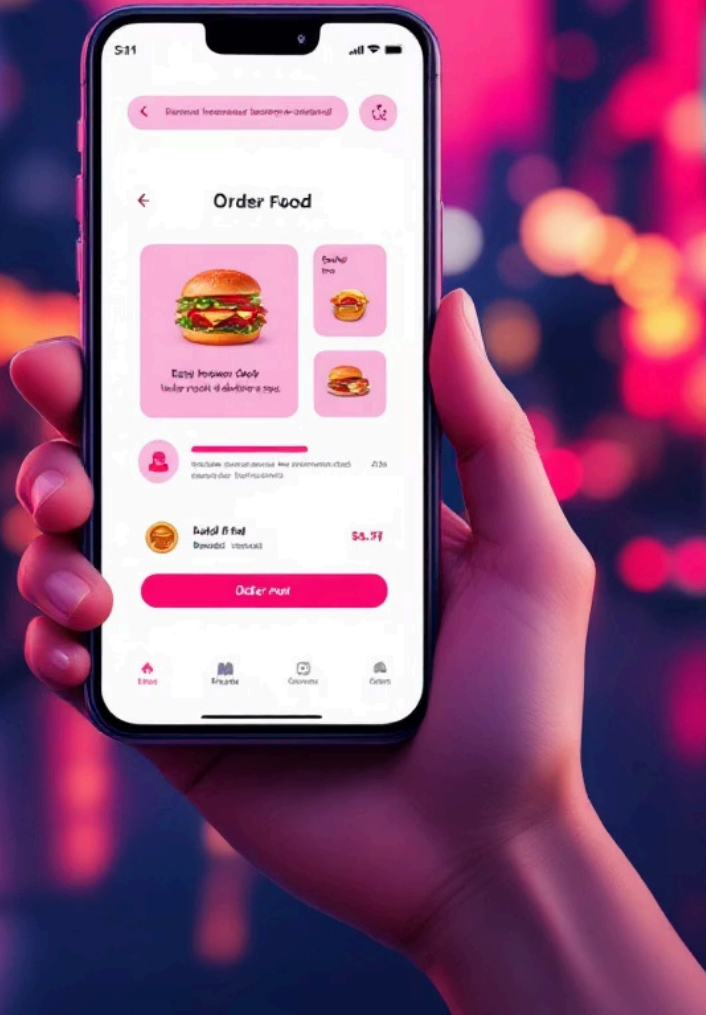




Scheduled Orders at Swiggy

A first-principles breakdown of why users default to instant ordering – and how we can redesign trust, flexibility, and adoption.

PRODUCT STRATEGY

UX RESEARCH



Why Users Default to Instant Ordering

Perceived Control

Ordering closer to the event feels more responsive – users stay in the driver's seat, reacting to how the moment unfolds.

Urban Unpredictability

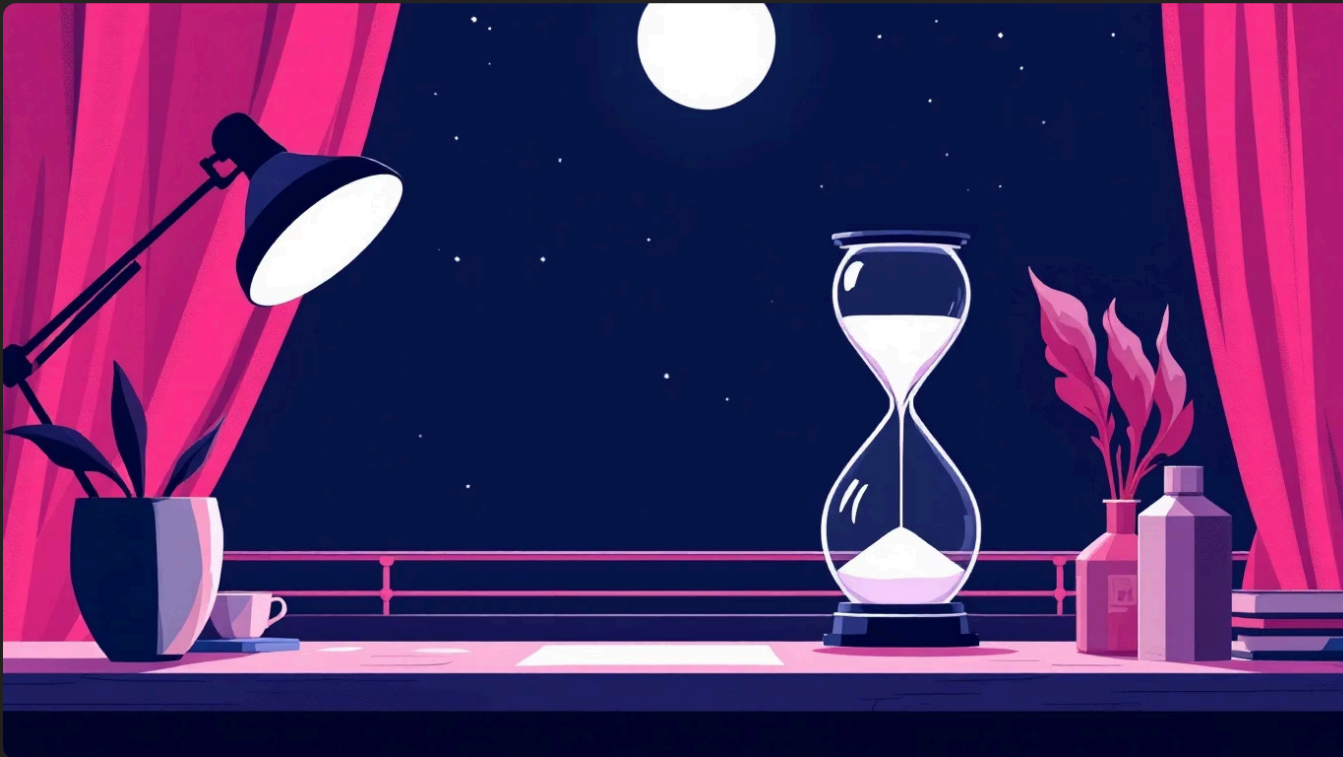
In Tier 1 cities, meetings overrun, guests arrive late, plans shift. Instant ordering feels built for that chaos.

Flexibility as Safety Net

Even if instant ordering carries risk, the ability to decide last-minute feels safer than committing hours ahead.

The Trust Gap in Advance Booking

Users don't distrust Swiggy – they distrust the *silence* between booking and delivery.



What Creates Doubt

- A long, invisible gap between booking and fulfillment
- No visible activity reassures users the order is progressing
- Pure trust replaces live feedback – a fragile foundation

□ When nothing seems to happen, anxiety fills the void.

What "Guarantee" Really Means to Users

Not Refunds

A refund cannot undo the social damage of a failed delivery at a party or team lunch.

Zero Embarrassment

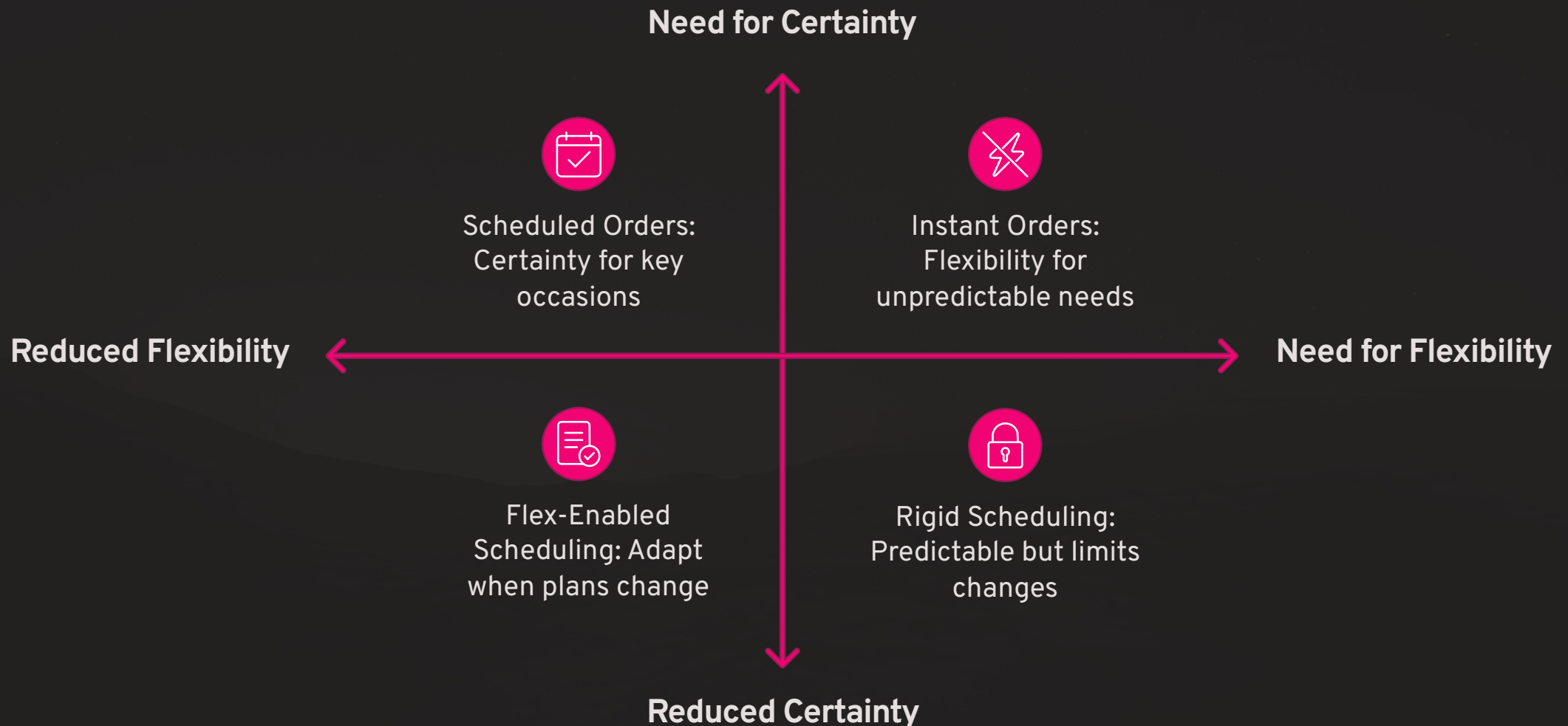
The real guarantee users want is smooth execution in front of guests or colleagues – no awkward moments.

Emotional Safety

Success = hosting that looks effortless. Failure = regret and self-blame for trusting a scheduled order.



The Root Psychological Tension



Scheduled Orders solve the **wrong half** of the equation unless flexibility is built in. The product must deliver both certainty *and* adaptability to unlock mass adoption.

Jobs-to-Be-Done: When Users Would Schedule



Weekend House Party

Exact timing, dietary variety, zero last-minute scramble.



Office Team Lunch

Synchronized delivery, dietary handling, lunch-window precision.



Festival Celebration

Reduce cooking load while preserving festive authenticity at peak demand.



Early Morning Travel

Strict punctuality, travel-friendly packaging, zero cancellation risk.

Adoption Anxieties & Competing Alternatives

What Users Fear

- Late or early delivery (cold food)
- Last-minute plan changes with no edit window
- Guest count uncertainty
- Freshness concerns & peak-hour trust gap

What They Hire Instead

- Instant ordering closer to event time
- Calling restaurants directly
- Hiring caterers or cooking at home
- Delegating someone for pickup

Every alternative on the right is a vote of no-confidence in Scheduled Orders. Removing friction on the left closes that gap.

Idea 1: Flexible Scheduling – Edit Until Prep Starts

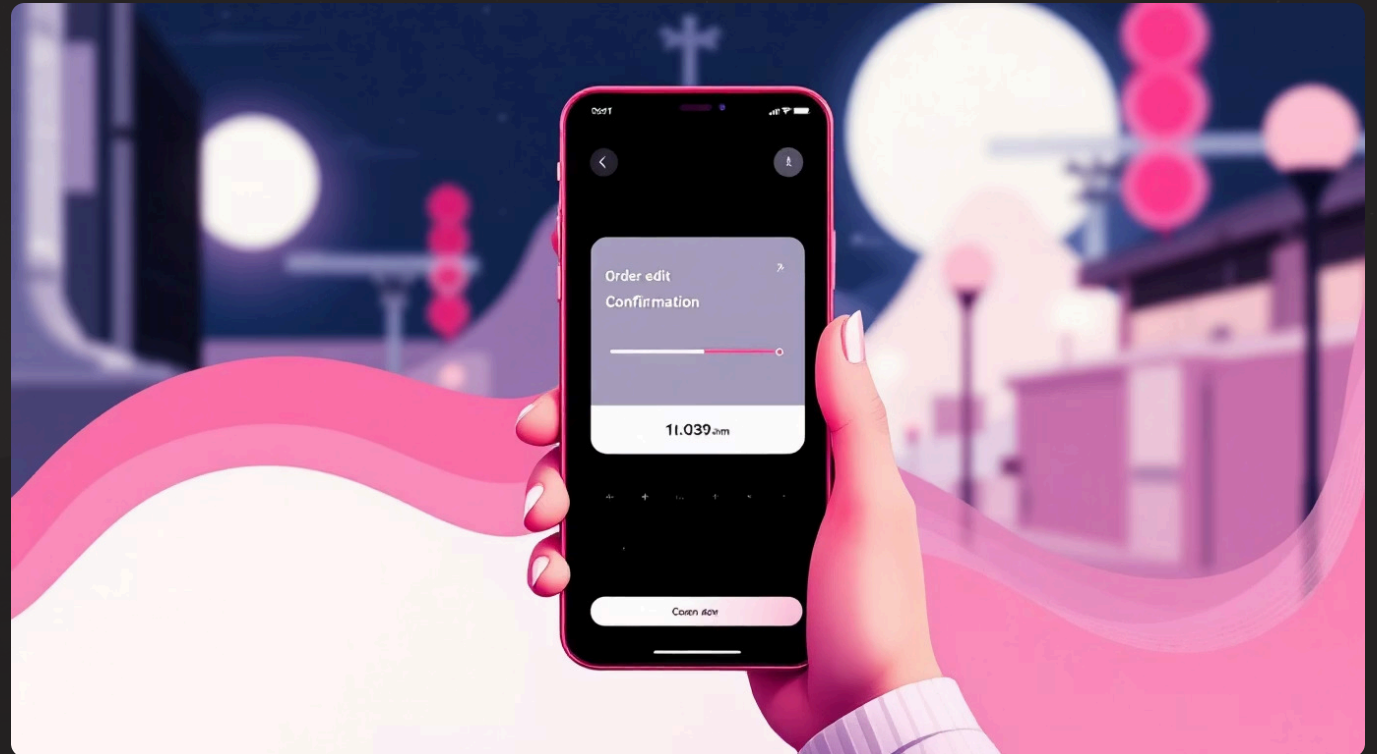
The Problem

Once scheduled, users feel *locked in*. Real life doesn't cooperate – guests arrive late, headcount shifts, meetings overrun.

The Solution

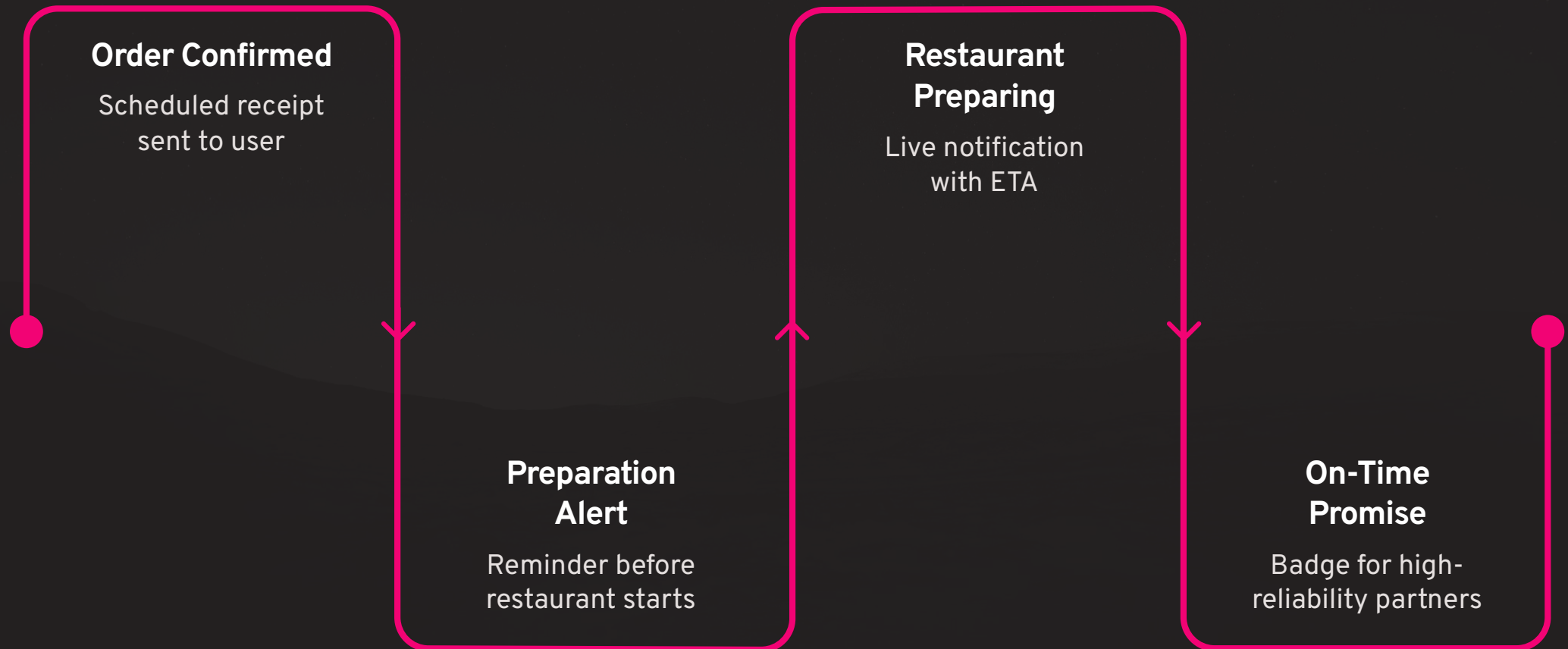
A clearly visible **"Edit Till X:XX PM"** window lets users modify delivery time, quantity, or items until the restaurant begins preparation.

- ❏ "You can edit this order until 5:30 PM" – one line that transforms perceived risk into confidence.



Idea 2: Progress Visibility & On-Time Assurance

The silent wait between scheduling and delivery is where trust erodes. Visibility rebuilds it.



Swiggy already has real-time tracking infrastructure. Extending it to scheduled states turns a passive wait into an **active, reassuring experience** — directly reducing pre-event anxiety.



Key Takeaways for Product & Design

01

Reframe the Value Prop

Scheduled Orders must sell **certainty + flexibility** – not just advance convenience.

02

Build the Edit Window

Allow modifications until prep begins. Reduce the psychological cost of committing early.

03

Make Progress Visible

Add checkpoints and an On-Time Promise badge to replace silence with reassurance.

04

Design for Social Stakes

Every feature decision should ask: *"Does this protect the user from embarrassment?"*